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RFP TEMPLATE · VERSION 2.2

Structured Cabling & Fiber Infrastructure RFP Template

A practical procurement template for IT directors, facility managers, and procurement professionals.

PROCUREMENT + FIELD EXECUTION GUIDE

References ANSI/TIA and BICSI structured cabling best practices.

What's Inside

This template is provided for general procurement guidance only.
Applicable standards, codes, licensing, safety, and Authority Having Jurisdiction (AHJ) requirements must be verified for each project and jurisdiction before issue. Version 2.2 · May 2026 ·

GUIDANCE

How to Use This Template

This template is a practical starting point — not a finished procurement package. The structure below walks the Owner from preparation to award and helps both sides arrive at a fair, comparable bid.

1. Prepare	Complete the RFP Readiness Checklist on the next page before issuing. Without estimated drop counts, site details, and scope decisions, bidders cannot give comparable pricing.
2. Customize	Fill in dates, contacts, scope checkboxes, owner specifications, line-item quantities, and qualification requirements. Use the assumptions/exclusions and OFCI sections to capture project-specific items.
3. Issue	Distribute as a single PDF to qualified bidders. Confirm receipt, schedule the site walk if applicable, and accept questions in writing only. Issue all clarifications as written addenda to all registered bidders.
4. Receive Bids	Verify each submittal against Section 08 Bid Submittal Checklist. Missing items should be handled according to the Owner's procurement rules; materially incomplete bids may be deemed non-responsive.
5. Evaluate	Use Section 07.4 Evaluation Matrix. Score technical, experience, price, schedule, and warranty/closeout commitments. Flag any bid more than 30% below median for clarification before award.
6. Award & Closeout	Issue notice of award, hold a kickoff, and enforce closeout deliverables (Section 05.4) before releasing final retainage. The closeout package is what protects the asset long-term.

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OWNER ACTION REQUIRED
Do not issue this RFP until estimated quantities are entered in Section 02.3 and the pricing schedule (Section 07.1). Bidders cannot provide comparable pricing without unit quantities.

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RCDD REVIEW NOTES
Have a licensed RCDD (Registered Communications Distribution Designer) review pathway sizing, fiber link budgets, grounding/bonding design, and labeling schema before issue. RCDD review is a cost-effective way to catch design issues before they become change orders during execution.

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FIELD NOTE
Templates are starting points, not finished engineering or legal documents. Project-specific requirements should be reviewed by the Owner, a licensed RCDD or design professional, AHJ, insurer, and procurement counsel before issue. AES does not provide legal advice.

PRE-ISSUE

RFP Readiness Checklist

Confirm each item below before issuing this RFP. Skipping items leads to vague bids, non-comparable pricing, and disputes during execution.

- ❑ Site address, building access, and operational hours documented
- ❑ TR / IDF / MDF list with room types, sizes, and rack quantities completed
- ❑ Fiber type, strand count, connector type, polish, polarity method, and pathway type selected
- ❑ Firestopping scope and responsibility defined (UL-listed systems where required)
- ❑ Work hours, blackout periods, after-hours requirements, and shutdown windows defined
- ❑ Testing requirements decided: Tier 1 only, or Tier 1 + Tier 2 OTDR for fiber
- ❑ Permit and AHJ inspection responsibility assigned
- ❑ Insurance limits set per Owner risk manager and jurisdiction requirements
- ❑ Mandatory vs preferred qualifications reviewed for project scope and size
- ❑ Estimated drop counts (work area outlets + AP drops + other) entered in Section 02.3
- ❑ Cable category (CAT6 / CAT6A) and construction (U/UTP / F/UTP) selected
- ❑ Pathway responsibility decided: who installs cable tray, conduit, J-hooks, innerduct
- ❑ Lift responsibility decided: Contractor-furnished or Owner-furnished
- ❑ Site access, badging, parking / loading dock, and escort procedures documented
- ❑ Closeout documentation expectations confirmed (Section 05.4)
- ❑ Owner-furnished materials list (OFCI) completed if applicable
- ❑ Evaluation weights confirmed in Section 07.2
- ❑ Estimated quantities entered in Section 07.1 pricing schedule

! **RISK ALERT**

If lift responsibility, work hours, access windows, firestopping, and patch cords are not defined, bidders may price different scopes — and the lowest bid may not be the real lowest cost once change orders pile up.

FIELD EXPERIENCE

Common RFP Mistakes to Avoid

Drawn from field execution across structured cabling, fiber, rack-and-stack, and wireless deployments. Each of these mistakes is easy to avoid in the RFP stage and expensive to fix in the field.

Issuing without drop counts

Without estimated quantities, bidders price assumptions instead of scope. Their assumptions will not match. You receive bids that cannot be compared and an award decision that is essentially a coin flip.

Leaving lift responsibility ambiguous

AP drops, high-ceiling work, and cable tray installation often require scissor or boom lifts. If the RFP does not say who furnishes the lift, half the bidders include it and half do not. This becomes a common change-order trigger.

Forgetting firestopping

Every wall, floor, and ceiling penetration needs a UL-listed firestop system. Owners frequently leave this out of the RFP. Then it gets added in the field at a premium with no competitive pricing.

No native test files

PDF-only summaries are harder to audit and may not preserve the full tester record. Always require native files from the approved certification platform (.flw, .SOR, .OFR, or equivalent). Native files make incomplete or failed results easier to audit.

Ignoring patch cords

Patch cords are not part of horizontal cabling and are often left out of bids. Patch cords may then be purchased later at higher cost and under schedule pressure.

Ambiguous after-hours work

If the data center cuts over at 2 AM Saturday, that is not standard labor. If the RFP does not specify work hours and the after-hours premium structure, expect re-pricing, delay, or schedule negotiation.

Releasing retainage before closeout

Once final payment is released, motivation to complete as-builts, label schema cross-references, and punch-list closure disappears. Hold retainage until the full closeout package is accepted.

Asking for "low-voltage license" only

License terminology varies by state and province. Use a jurisdiction-neutral requirement so qualified bidders are not disqualified by terminology mismatches.

Accepting "BICSI-certified" without proof

BICSI has multiple certifications (Installer 1, Installer 2 Copper, Installer 2 Fiber, RCDD, DCDC). Require the specific credential needed for the work and ask for current credential cards.

Treating lowest price as the answer

A bid 30% below median almost always reflects missing scope, optimistic crew size, or compressed schedule. Use the Evaluation Matrix and flag outliers for clarification before award.

SECTION 00

Instructions to Bidders

■ Read this section carefully before preparing your proposal. Proposals that are materially incomplete or non-responsive may be rejected at the Owner's discretion.

0.1 Key Dates & Deadlines

Milestone	Date / Time	Notes
RFP Issue Date		Owner to complete before issuing
Pre-Bid Site Walk		See 0.3 for site walk type (mandatory / optional / not required)
Deadline — Written Questions		Questions received after this date will not be answered
Addendum Issue Date (if any)		All addenda supersede the original RFP
Proposal Due Date & Time		Late submissions will not be accepted
Anticipated Award Date		
Anticipated Project Start		

0.2 Submission Requirements

Proposals must be submitted as a single PDF. Hard copy submissions will not be accepted unless noted in an addendum. Proposals must include:

- Cover letter on company letterhead, signed by an authorized representative
- Completed pricing schedule (Section 07) — all applicable line items priced; non-applicable items marked N/A with explanation
- Proposed project schedule — milestone-level Gantt or equivalent
- Assumptions, exclusions, owner-furnished materials, and any proposed deviations from stated scope
- Company qualifications and references per Section 06 requirements
- Proof of insurance naming Owner as additional insured (certificate of insurance)
- Credential cards for assigned lead technicians and OSHA / provincial safety documentation for all field personnel as required

0.3 Point of Contact & Questions

All questions must be submitted in writing to the contact below. Oral responses are not binding. Questions received by the deadline will be answered via written addendum issued to all registered bidders / plan holders.

Point of Contact — Name & Title		Email Address	
Phone		Issuing Organization	

Site Walk Status	❑ Mandatory	❑ Optional	❑ Not Required

0.4 General Conditions

Right to Reject	Owner reserves the right to reject any or all proposals, waive informalities, and award in the best interest of the project.
Addenda	Only written addenda issued by the Owner are binding. Bidders are responsible for confirming receipt of all addenda before submission and acknowledging them in Section 08.
Bid Validity	Proposals shall remain valid for 90 days from the due date unless otherwise noted in an addendum.
Pre-Bid Site Walk	If the site walk is marked Mandatory in 0.3, bidders must attend to remain eligible. If marked Optional, attendance is strongly encouraged. Bidders who do not attend remain responsible for understanding visible site conditions.
Substitutions	Proposed substitutions to specified materials require written pre-approval at least 5 business days before the proposal due date.
Subcontractors	List all proposed subcontractors and their scope in the proposal. Owner reserves the right to reject proposed subcontractors.
Site Access & Work Hours	Specify standard work hours, after-hours requirements, blackout periods, escort / badging procedures, parking / loading dock access, and access-control restrictions in 1.3.
Permits & AHJ	Owner shall identify who obtains and pays for required permits and inspections, and the level of AHJ coordination required for the project.

0.5 Addenda Acknowledgment

Bidder shall acknowledge receipt of all addenda issued by the Owner. List addendum number and date received.

Addendum #	Date Received	Acknowledged By

SECTION 01

Project Information & Scope of Work

1.1 Issuing Organization

Organization / Company Name		Primary Contact Name & Title	
Mailing Address		City, State / Province, ZIP / Postal	
Phone		Email Address	
RFP Reference Number		Issue Date	
Proposal Due Date & Time		Submission Method	

1.2 Project Description

Summarize the project: purpose (new build / refresh / expansion), expected start date, and any critical constraints bidders must know.

1.3 Scope of Work

Check all items included in this engagement. Bidders must price all checked items and identify assumptions, exclusions, and Owner-furnished materials.

- ❑ Site survey and pathway design prior to installation
- ❑ Horizontal copper cabling — CAT6 / CAT6A (specify in Section 03)
- ❑ Backbone fiber cabling — multimode / single-mode (specify in Section 04)
- ❑ Telecommunications room buildout: racks, patch panels, cable management, labeling
- ❑ Pathway installation: cable tray, conduit, J-hooks, innerduct
- ❑ Grounding and bonding per latest Owner-adopted ANSI/TIA bonding and grounding/earthing standard and AHJ requirements
- ❑ Field certification testing — copper and fiber
- ❑ Labeling of all cables, panels, and outlets per Owner-approved label schema and applicable ANSI/TIA administration standard
- ❑ As-built drawings, test reports, label schedule, and closeout package
- ❑ Project management, daily progress reporting, and site safety compliance
- ❑ Demolition and removal of abandoned cable per NEC/CEC/local code and Owner direction
- ❑ Firestopping at wall / floor / ceiling penetrations — UL-listed assemblies, documentation submitted
- ❑ Patch cords — quantity and length per Owner direction; included unless noted otherwise
- ❑ Lift rental and operation (scissor / boom) — Contractor-furnished unless noted Owner-furnished
- ❑ Permits and AHJ inspections — Contractor obtains unless noted Owner-obtained
- ❑ After-hours / weekend / shutdown-window work — pricing premium identified in Section 07
- ❑ Network device configuration (switch / AP / VLAN / patching) — EXCLUDED unless explicitly checked
- ❑ Owner-furnished, Contractor-installed materials — list provided in 1.4

1.4 Owner-Furnished Contractor-Installed Materials (OFCI)

List Owner-furnished materials that the Contractor will install. Include manufacturer, model, quantity, and delivery method (drop-shipped to site / Owner staging / etc.).

Manufacturer	Model / Part #	Qty	Delivery Method

1.5 Assumptions, Exclusions & Clarifications

Bidders shall list assumptions, exclusions, and clarifications affecting their proposal. Without this, the Owner may receive non-comparable bids. Use the structured prompts below; expand each entry as needed.

1.5 Assumptions, Exclusions & Clarifications (continued)

Assumed labor model Standard business hours, single shift, M–F unless after-hours premium identified in 7.1.	
Assumed access conditions Site access during work hours, escort provided by Owner, parking / loading dock available.	
Assumed pathway condition Existing pathways usable as-installed; new pathways priced in 7.1 where checked in 1.3.	
Assumed lift availability Contractor-furnished scissor or boom lift where required, billed per 7.1 line 22.	
Assumed test scope Tier 1 IL bi-directional for fiber; Tier 2 OTDR only where checked. Copper: permanent link.	
Excluded scope Network device configuration, programming, VLAN assignments, and active equipment commissioning.	
Excluded materials Owner-furnished equipment (see OFCI list 1.4); patch cords over Owner-specified quantity.	
Clarifications Note any deviations from specified manufacturer, polarity method, or termination method.	

i **FIELD NOTE**
Vague assumptions are the single biggest cause of non-comparable bids. Asking each bidder to list assumptions in the same structure makes the eventual award decision defensible.

SECTION 02

Site Details & Telecommunications Room Schedule

2.1 Facility Information

Site Address		Building Type	
Total Gross Square Footage		Number of Occupied Floors	
Number of Buildings / Wings		Ceiling Height (typical)	
Existing Cable Infrastructure		Year Constructed / Last Refresh	
Pathway Constraints		Power / Cooling / Access Notes	

2.2 Telecommunications Room (TR) Schedule

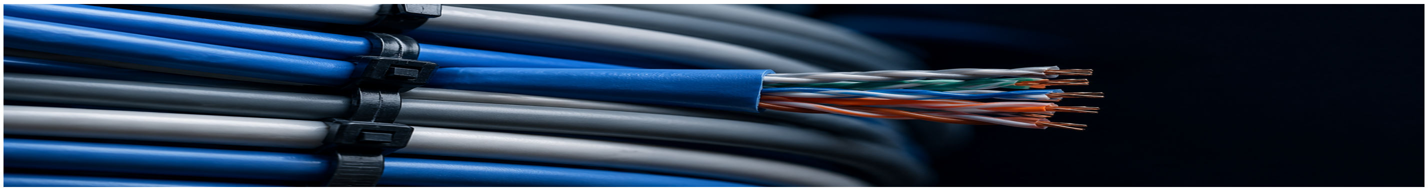
Complete one row per TR / IDF / MDF location. Add rows as needed.

TR ID	Location / Floor	Room Type	Size (sq ft)	Status	Existing Racks	New Racks
TR-01						
TR-02						
TR-03						
TR-04						
TR-05						
TR-06						

2.3 Drop Count Estimate

Drop counts are planning estimates for bid comparison and unit-price extension. Final quantities shall be verified during site walk, Owner review, or approved change process unless issued as binding quantities.

Zone / Floor	Work Area Outlets	AP Drops	Other	Total Drops
TOTAL				



SECTION 03

Copper Cabling Specifications

All copper cabling shall comply with the ANSI/TIA-568.2 series (latest Owner-adopted edition). Use the Owner Selection column to specify your requirements. The Reference / Guidance column is for evaluator context only — it does not set project requirements.

3.1 Horizontal Copper — Owner Specification

Parameter	Owner Selection	Reference / Guidance
Cable Category		CAT6A required for 10GBase-T up to 100 m. CAT6 may be acceptable where project requirements are limited to 1G applications and 10GBase-T is not required.
Cable Construction		F/UTP may be required in high-EMI environments (factories, hospitals, near heavy electrical equipment). Shielded systems require continuous bonding and grounding design.
Max Horizontal Run	90 m permanent link / 100 m channel	Per applicable ANSI/TIA-568.2 series requirements (latest Owner-adopted edition). Measure cable path, not straight-line distance.
Connector Pinout		Choose T568A or T568B and apply consistently throughout the project. Mixing causes wiring faults.
Fire / Plenum Rating		CMP or applicable plenum-rated cable required where mandated by NEC/CEC/local code and AHJ.
Outlets per WAO		Dual-gang faceplate with 2 ports is standard for office environments.
Accepted Manufacturers		System warranty eligibility shall be based on approved components, authorized installer status, manufacturer requirements, and completed registration.
Testing Standard	ANSI/TIA-1152-A · Level IIIe or Level IV tester	Fluke DSX-8000, VIAVI Certifier40G, or approved equal. Tester model, adapter type, calibration status, and firmware version shall appear on submitted reports.

3.2 Additional Copper Notes

Enter any project-specific copper requirements, approved substitutions, or scope exceptions below.

SECTION 04

Fiber Cabling Specifications

All fiber cabling shall comply with the ANSI/TIA-568.3 series (latest Owner-adopted edition). Use the Owner Selection column to specify your requirements. The Reference / Guidance column is for evaluator context only.

4.1 Backbone Fiber — Owner Specification

Parameter	Owner Selection	Reference / Guidance
Fiber Type		OS2 for campus / inter-building runs. OM4 / OM5 for intra-building and data center. OM5 supports short-wave WDM.
Strand Count		Specify per route or per TR-to-TR run. Account for current need plus spare strands (typically 25–50% spare for backbone).
Cable Jacket / Rating		OFNP (plenum), OFNR (riser), OFNG/OFN (general), or LSZH. Outdoor: armored or non-armored, water-blocked, UV-rated as applicable.
Pathway Type		Indoor / OSP / direct-buried / aerial / innerduct. OSP and direct-buried have different cable construction and termination requirements.
Polarity Method		Methods A, B, or C per ANSI/TIA-568.3 series. Maintain consistent polarity throughout the system. Required for MPO/MTP trunk + module deployments.
Min Bend Radius	Per cable manufacturer specification	Honored during pull, after-install, and in cable management. Violating bend radius causes long-term attenuation/failures.
Spare Strands		Recommended 25–50% spare for backbone runs. Document spare strand count in closeout package.
Connector Type		LC duplex is the industry standard for equipment patch connections. MPO is preferred for pre-terminated trunk cabling.
Polish Type		APC required where return loss is critical (DWDM, passive optical networks). APC and UPC connectors shall not be mated together.
Max IL per Connector	≤ 0.75 dB per mated pair (ANSI/TIA-568.3 series)	Per ANSI/TIA-568.3 series loss budget. Use approved field tester referenced and calibrated against the selected wavelengths.
End-Face Inspection	Pass per IEC 61300-3-35	Inspect with approved fiber inspection scope and cleaning procedure prior to mating.
Termination Method		Factory assemblies provide better insertion loss and warranty coverage. Fusion splicing may be required for OSP / campus runs depending on design, restoration requirements, pathway, and Owner standards.
Accepted Manufacturers		System warranty eligibility shall be based on approved components, authorized installer status, manufacturer requirements, and completed registration.
Testing Standard	TIA-526.14 series (MM) · TIA-526-7 (SM)	Tier 1 insertion loss testing required. Tier 2 OTDR testing shall be provided where specified by scope, warranty, link criticality, or Owner requirements. Tester model and calibration shall appear on reports.

4.2 Fiber Selection Checklist

Confirm each item before issue. These design decisions drive cost, schedule, and warranty eligibility — leaving them ambiguous is a common cause of mid-project change orders.

❑ Strand count and spare strand allocation confirmed for each backbone run

❑ Fiber type (OM3 / OM4 / OM5 / OS2) selected and approved by Owner

❑ Polarity method (A, B, or C) selected and consistent end-to-end

❑ Termination method (factory pre-terminated vs field termination) decided

❑ Pathway type (innerduct, conduit, cable tray, J-hook) defined for each segment

❑ Minimum bend radius and pull tension limits documented in scope

❑ Service loop / slack storage strategy defined at each LIU / patch location

❑ Jacket rating (OFNP / OFNR / LSZH / OSP) selected per pathway type and AHJ

❑ Labeling schema confirmed and matches Owner CMDB / asset records

❑ Testing tier (Tier 1 IL only vs Tier 1 + Tier 2 OTDR) decided and documented

❑ Approved manufacturer(s) and authorized installer requirements confirmed for warranty

❑ System warranty term (15 / 20 / 25 yr) selected and registration responsibility assigned

4.3 Additional Fiber Notes

Enter any project-specific fiber requirements, approved substitutions, or scope exceptions below.

SECTION 05

Testing, Labeling & Closeout Documentation

5.1 Copper Acceptance Criteria — All Links Must Pass

All copper links shall receive a PASS result using an approved field certification tester configured for the applicable cable category, test limit, and permanent-link or channel configuration required by the project.

Test Parameter	Pass Criterion
Wire Map	Correct pin-to-pin; no opens, shorts, reversed pairs, or split pairs
Length	Within permanent link (90 m) or channel (100 m) maximum
Insertion Loss	Pass per approved field tester against the selected cable category and approved permanent-link / channel test limit
NEXT / PS-NEXT	Pass per approved field tester against the selected cable category and approved permanent-link / channel test limit
ACR-F / PSACR-F	Pass per approved field tester against the selected cable category and approved permanent-link / channel test limit (per ANSI/TIA-568.2 series)
Return Loss	Pass per approved field tester against the selected cable category and approved permanent-link / channel test limit
Propagation Delay	≤ 570 ns at 100 MHz
Delay Skew	≤ 50 ns between any two pairs

5.2 Fiber Acceptance Criteria

Fiber links shall meet the approved link budget and manufacturer / Owner requirements.

Test	Standard	Wavelength	Pass Criterion
Insertion Loss — MM	TIA-526.14 series	850 nm / 1300 nm	≤ calculated link budget (OFL)
Insertion Loss — SM	TIA-526-7	1310 nm / 1550 nm	≤ calculated link budget (FOTP-78)
OTDR — MM (Tier 2 if required)	TIA-FOTP-60	850 nm / 1300 nm	No unexpected events; connector/splice loss and reflectance to meet approved link budget and manufacturer requirements
OTDR — SM (Tier 2 if required)	TIA-FOTP-60	1310 nm / 1550 nm	No unexpected events; splice loss ≤ 0.15 dB (typical) and reflectance to meet approved link budget
End-Face Inspection	IEC 61300-3-35	N/A	Pass per IEC 61300-3-35 using approved fiber inspection scope and cleaning procedure

5.3 Label Schema

Labeling shall follow the Owner-approved label schema and applicable ANSI/TIA administration standard. Labels shall match the cable schedule, patch panel records, and closeout documentation.

Element	Format	Example
Horizontal Cable	[TR-ID]-[Panel]-[Port]	TR-01-PP-A-01
Backbone Fiber	[Origin]-[Dest]-[Count]-[Type]	TR-01-MDF-12F-SM
Outlet / WAO	Room number + port number; matches patch panel port record	RM-114-P03
TR / Room	Room designation on door and inside near light switch	TR-01
Rack ID	Front top and bottom verticals; both sides of rack	R-01-A

5.4 Closeout Documentation Package

All items below are required for final project acceptance and release of final payment / retainage. Use checkboxes to confirm inclusion in your proposal.

❑ As-built drawings (PDF + DWG) — all cable routes, TR locations, and pathways

❑ Cable schedule (XLSX) — every link: ID, origin, destination, type, test result, label

❑ Copper test reports — PDF summaries and native files from the approved certification platform (.flw or equivalent), every link

❑ Fiber test reports — IL results required (PDF + native files from approved tester platform: .SOR, .OFR, or equivalent); OTDR traces where Tier 2 specified

❑ Label schema master list (XLSX) — physical label ↔ cable ID cross-reference

❑ Manufacturer warranty registration confirmations, registered in Owner's name

❑ Material submittals — data sheets for all cable, connectors, and hardware installed

❑ Firestop documentation — UL-listed or approved firestop system documentation where applicable

❑ Photo log — installation photos of TR rooms, racks, pathways, terminations, labels, and final state

❑ Tester calibration certificates — current calibration status for all field certification equipment used

❑ Final redline drawings — as-installed deviations from issued drawings, dated and signed

❑ Signed punch list clearance — all items resolved before final payment release

REFERENCE

Sample Closeout Package

This is what "clean closeout" looks like in practice. AES recommends the structure below and uses it as a standard closeout model where applicable. Owners should require equivalent deliverables from any cabling contractor before releasing final payment or retainage.

Sample Cable Schedule (XLSX)

Cable ID	Path (Origin → Dest)	Type	Length	Result	Label	Date
TR-01-PP-A-01	RM-114-P03 → TR-01 / PP-A Port 01	CAT6A U/UTP	78 m	PASS	TR01-PP-A-01	05/14/26
TR-01-PP-A-02	RM-114-P04 → TR-01 / PP-A Port 02	CAT6A U/UTP	79 m	PASS	TR01-PP-A-02	05/14/26
TR-01-PP-B-01	RM-118 AP-01 → TR-01 / PP-B Port 01	CAT6A U/UTP	62 m	PASS	TR01-PP-B-01	05/14/26
TR01-MDF-12F-SM-01	TR-01 LIU-A → MDF LIU-A	OS2 12F	184 m	PASS	TR01-MDF-12F-SM	05/15/26
…	…	…	…	…	…	…

Sample Test Report Index

File	Tester	Calibration	Wavelength / Limit	Link Count	Pass
copper_perm_link_TR01.flw	Fluke DSX-8000	03/12/26	TIA Cat6A Perm Link	48	48
copper_perm_link_TR02.flw	Fluke DSX-8000	03/12/26	TIA Cat6A Perm Link	32	32
fiber_TR01_MDF_OS2.SOR	VIAVI MTS-2000	02/28/26	1310 / 1550 nm	12 strands	12
fiber_TR01_MDF_OS2_IL.OFR	VIAVI Certifier40G	02/28/26	Tier 1 IL bidirectional	12 strands	12
…	…	…	…	…	…

Sample Punch List Tracker

#	Item	Location	Owner	Status	Closed
1	Mislabeled patch panel port	TR-01 PP-B Port 14	Contractor	Closed	05/16/26
2	Missing firestop sleeve	Wall penetration RM-118 → corridor	Contractor	Closed	05/17/26
3	Failed link re-terminate	TR-02 PP-A Port 09	Contractor	Closed	05/17/26
4	As-built drawing markup	TR-01 backbone path	Contractor	Closed	05/18/26
…	…	…	…	…	…

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CLOSEOUT REQUIREMENT

Closeout is what protects the asset for the next 10–20 years. The cable schedule + label schema + test reports + as-built drawings should make any future technician (or any future RFP) faster, cheaper, and lower-risk. Without it, future work starts from scratch.

SECTION 06

Vendor Qualifications & Insurance

6.1 Mandatory Qualifications

Firms not meeting the mandatory requirements below may be deemed non-responsive at the Owner's discretion. Submit supporting documentation with your proposal.

Requirement	Standard / Issuing Body	Proof Required
BICSI Installer 2 (Copper or Optical Fiber) for lead technicians, RCDD for design-build scopes, OR qualified supervisor identified — applicable where required by project scope or warranty	BICSI International	Copy of current credential card for each assigned lead
Manufacturer Authorized Installer (cable + connector system)	Belden, CommScope, Panduit, Leviton, or approved equal	Letter of authorization — required only where Owner specifies a manufacturer system warranty
Low-Voltage / Electrical / Telecommunications Contractor License	State, provincial, municipal, or trade license required by project jurisdiction and scope	Current license number and expiry; copy of certificate
Minimum 5 years installing structured cabling at comparable scale	Bidder statement plus references	3 verifiable references — projects ≥ 200 drops, completed in past 3 years
Safety Training for all on-site technicians	OSHA 10 or OSHA 30 (U.S.) — or applicable provincial / territorial safety training documentation (Canada)	Copy of safety card / certificate for every technician assigned

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FIELD NOTE

For smaller projects (under 200 drops or no manufacturer system warranty required), the Owner may waive BICSI Installer 2 and Manufacturer Authorized Installer requirements in favor of a qualified field supervisor identified by the bidder. Adjust mandatory clauses to match project scope.

6.2 Preferred / Scored Qualifications

The following will be scored but are not mandatory. Bidders should indicate which apply.

- ❑ RCDD on staff for design review
- ❑ BICSI DCDC (Data Center Design Consultant) credential on staff
- ❑ ISO 9001 or equivalent quality management certification
- ❑ OSHA VPP, COR, or equivalent safety program certification
- ❑ Established local presence within 100 km / 60 miles of project site

6.3 Insurance Requirements

Coverage Type	Minimum Limit	Additional Insured
Commercial General Liability	$2,000,000 per occurrence / $4,000,000 aggregate	Owner to be named
Workers' Compensation (U.S. and / or WSIB / WCB / provincial equivalent in Canada)	Statutory — per state / province	N/A
Employer's Liability	$1,000,000 per occurrence	N/A
Commercial Auto Liability	$1,000,000 CSL	Owner to be named
Professional Liability (E&O) — where design or design-build scope	$1,000,000 per claim	Owner to be named

6.4 Workmanship Warranty

Bidder shall provide an installation workmanship warranty covering defects in materials supplied by Contractor and installation labor. State warranty duration and any exclusions. Where the manufacturer system warranty (typically 20–25 years) is required, Contractor is responsible for registration in the Owner's name and meeting all eligibility requirements.

Workmanship Warranty — Duration	
Manufacturer System Warranty — Years	
Exclusions / Conditions	

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FIELD NOTE

Manufacturer warranty does not replace workmanship responsibility for installation defects. Even when a 20–25 year manufacturer system warranty is in place, the Contractor remains liable for poor terminations, mislabeled links, incorrect polarity, and pathway/firestop deficiencies.

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RISK ALERT

Manufacturer system warranties may be voided, rejected, or delayed when: (a) the installer is not an authorized partner; (b) approved components are mixed with non-approved components; (c) registration is not completed within the manufacturer's required window after final test; or (d) test results do not meet the manufacturer's acceptance criteria. Confirm all four conditions before releasing final payment.

6.5 Warranty Period — Owner Notes

Capture any project-specific warranty conditions, exclusions, or service-level expectations below.

SECTION 07

Pricing Schedule & Evaluation Matrix

7.1 Unit Pricing Schedule

Unit pricing is required for all applicable line items. Owner may also request a base lump-sum summary using the estimated quantities provided. Non-applicable line items shall be marked N/A with explanation. Owner reserves the right to increase or decrease quantities against unit rates.

Owner action required before issuing: Insert estimated quantities in the Est. Qty column. Bidders will complete Unit Price and Extended columns. Do not issue without quantities.

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BID COMPARISON TIP

This PDF form is manual-entry. Fields do not auto-calculate. Bidders are responsible for verifying all arithmetic. Unit prices govern over extended totals in the event of any discrepancy.

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FIELD NOTE

Require native test files (.flw, .SOR, .OFR, or equivalent), not just PDF summaries. Native files make incomplete or failed certification results easier to audit and give the Owner a defensible audit trail.

#	Description	Unit	Est. Qty	Unit Price ($)	Extended ($)
1	CAT6A U/UTP cable — installed, terminated both ends, labeled	Drop			
2	CAT6A F/UTP (shielded) cable — installed, terminated, labeled	Drop			
3	CAT6A 24-port patch panel — installed and labeled	Each			
4	CAT6A keystone jack + 2-port faceplate — installed and labeled	WAO			
5	OM4 fiber backbone — per foot installed (pull + termination)	LF			
6	OS2 single-mode backbone — per foot installed	LF			
7	LC duplex fiber enclosure, 24-port, rack-mount — installed	Each			
8	MPO/MTP pre-terminated trunk, 12F OM4 (specify length)	Each			
9	Open-frame 42U rack — installed, grounded, labeled	Each			
10	Horizontal cable manager 1U — installed	Each			
11	6-inch galvanized cable tray — installed with supports	LF			
12	3/4-inch EMT conduit — installed with fittings	LF			
13	Firestop sleeve / system at wall or floor penetration	Each			
14	Copper certification test (permanent link or channel) — per link	Link			
15	Fiber Tier 1 IL test — both directions, per link	Link			
16	Fiber Tier 2 OTDR test — where specified, per link	Link			
17	TMGB / TGB ground bar — installed and bonded	Each			
18	Closeout documentation package — all deliverables per Section 5.4	Lump			
19	Mobilization / demobilization	Lump			

#	Description	Unit	Est. Qty	Unit Price ($)	Extended ($)
20	Project Management (PM) — duration of project	Lump			
21	Site survey (post-award, if required)	Lump			
22	Lift rental (scissor / boom) — per day	Day			
23	After-hours / weekend labor premium (% over standard labor rate)	%			
24	Travel and per diem (when project is > 50 mi / 80 km from base of operations)	Lump			
25	Demolition / removal of abandoned cable per NEC/CEC/local code	Drop			
26	Patch cords — CAT6A, length / qty per Owner direction	Each			
27	Permits and inspections (where Contractor is responsible)	Lump			
28	As-built drafting (PDF + DWG)	Lump			
29	Change-order labor — Technician hourly rate	Hr			
30	Change-order labor — Lead / Foreman hourly rate	Hr			
31	Change-order labor — PM hourly rate	Hr			
32	Change-order — Material markup over invoice	%			
TOTAL BID					

Note: extended-column and total-bid arithmetic shall be verified by the bidder. Bidder shall confirm sum of extended values equals total bid.

7.2 Alternate Pricing Lines (Add / Deduct Alternates)

Bidders shall price the alternates below. Each alternate is independent and may be accepted or rejected at the Owner's discretion. Use Add (+) for added scope and Deduct (–) for value engineering.

Alt #	Description	Type	Unit	Est. Qty	Unit Price ($)	Extended ($)
A-1	Upgrade horizontal cabling from CAT6 to CAT6A (price differential per drop)	Add	Drop			
A-2	Shielded F/UTP system in lieu of U/UTP (per drop)	Add	Drop			
A-3	OS2 single-mode backbone in lieu of OM4 (per foot)	Add	LF			
A-4	Tier 2 OTDR testing for all backbone fiber links	Add	Link			
A-5	Pre-terminated MPO trunk system in lieu of field-terminated	Add	Each			
A-6	After-hours installation window (weekend / overnight) — 100% of scope	Add	Lump			
A-7	Owner-furnished patch cords (delete Contractor-supplied patch cords)	Deduct	Each			
A-8	Manufacturer 25-year system warranty (registration + eligibility)	Add	Lump			
A-9	Additional 25% spare strands on backbone fiber routes	Add	LF			
A-10	Performance bond (if required)	Add	Lump			

7.3 Base Bid Summary

In addition to the unit pricing schedule above, bidders shall provide the following base bid summary. In case of arithmetic discrepancy between unit prices and totals, unit prices shall govern.

Base Bid — Sum of Extended Line Items (Section 7.1)	
Alternates / Add-Alternates (list separately — see 7.2)	
Allowances (e.g., contingency, owner-directed work)	
Applicable Taxes (where required by jurisdiction)	
Bonds (where required)	
TOTAL BID PRICE (excludes alternates unless accepted by Owner)	

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BID COMPARISON TIP
A bid more than 30% below the median should be flagged for clarification before award. Confirm labor assumptions, material scope, testing scope, access assumptions, and exclusions — the lowest bid may not be the lowest cost.

7.4 Proposal Evaluation Matrix

Criterion	Weight	What Evaluators Are Looking For
Technical Approach & Methodology	25%	Quality of installation process; QC and testing workflow; repeatable deployment standa
Relevant Experience & References	25%	Comparable project scope in past 3 years; BICSI credential compliance; reference qua
Price	25%	Lowest compliant bid scored at full weight; others scaled proportionally. Bids more tha
Proposed Project Schedule	15%	Realism and detail of milestone schedule; ability to meet required completion date
Warranty & Closeout Commitments	10%	Manufacturer system warranty eligibility; quality of proposed closeout deliverables; wo
TOTAL	**100%**	

How to score: Each criterion is scored 0–100 and multiplied by its weight. For Price, the lowest compliant unit-price total receives the full Price weight (25%); other bidders receive a proportional score using Score = (Lowest Compliant Price / Bidder Price) × Weight. Flag any bid more than 30% below the median for clarification before award. Recommend award to the highest weighted total from a technically qualified firm.

7.5 Change Order Process

All scope changes shall be documented via written change order signed by Owner and Contractor before work proceeds. Change-order pricing shall use the labor rates and material markup specified in Section 7.1. Time impact, if any, shall be identified in writing within 5 business days.

7.6 Payment Terms & Retainage

Payment Terms	
Retainage %	
Retainage Release Trigger (e.g., punch-list closure + closeout package acceptance)	

SECTION 08

Bid Submittal Checklist & Bidder Certification

Complete this checklist before submitting your proposal. All items marked Required must be included. Proposals missing required items may be deemed non-responsive at the Owner's discretion.

8.1 Proposal Package — Required Items

- ❑ Cover letter on company letterhead, signed by authorized representative
- ❑ Completed pricing schedule (Section 07) — all applicable line items priced; non-applicable items marked N/A with explanation
- ❑ Proposed project schedule — milestone Gantt or equivalent, with completion date
- ❑ Three verifiable project references (projects ≥ 200 drops, past 3 years)
- ❑ Copy of current BICSI Installer 2 or RCDD credential card for each assigned lead, as required by Section 06 and project scope
- ❑ OSHA 10 / 30 (U.S.) or equivalent provincial / territorial safety documentation (Canada) for every technician assigned
- ❑ Manufacturer letter of authorization (required for system warranty eligibility)
- ❑ Current state / provincial / municipal license per project jurisdiction — copy and number
- ❑ Certificate of insurance — all coverages per Section 6.3, Owner named as additional insured
- ❑ List of proposed subcontractors with scope description (if any)
- ❑ Assumptions, exclusions, and clarifications per Section 1.5
- ❑ Addenda acknowledgment per Section 0.5

8.2 Recommended Additions (Scored — Not Disqualifying)

- ❑ Written methodology describing installation process, QC checkpoints, and testing workflow
- ❑ Site safety plan or reference to company safety program
- ❑ Manufacturer pre-qualification letter confirming system warranty eligibility
- ❑ Sample closeout documentation package from a comparable completed project
- ❑ List of clarifying questions or proposed scope exceptions with rationale

8.3 Bidder Certification

By submitting this proposal, the undersigned certifies that: (a) all information provided is accurate and complete; (b) the firm meets all qualification requirements stated herein; (c) the pricing submitted is valid for 90 days from the proposal due date; (d) the bidder acknowledges receipt of all addenda listed in Section 0.5; (e) the bidder has identified all assumptions, exclusions, and clarifications in Section 1.5; and (f) the signer represents they are authorized to bind the company.

Authorized Signature		Date	
Printed Name		Title	
Company Name		Phone	
Addenda Acknowledged (range)		Email	
Tax ID / Business Reg. #		State / Prov.	

Need a field execution partner to support this scope?

AES is a North America-based infrastructure deployment partner specializing in structured cabling, fiber optics, rack-and-stack, and large-scale AP rollouts. We work as a trusted subcontract execution partner for primes, integrators, and enterprise IT teams.

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Execution-oriented delivery

Field coordination, tested workmanship, and documentation-ready handover — built to support on-schedule, specification-driven delivery.

Credential-aware crews

BICSI-informed field standards and qualified leads aligned to scope requirements and jurisdiction-specific safety documentation.

Closeout-focused process

As-builts, test reports, cable schedules, and warranty documentation organized for handover, aligned to the owner-approved label schema.

15-MIN SCOPE REVIEW

Need help scoping or executing this project?

Send us your floor plans, drop counts, or RFP draft.
AES can help validate scope, identify missing line items,
and support field execution across the U.S. and Canada.
apexsolutions.io · info@apexsolutions.io · (669) 251-7810

Scan to book a 15-min scope review.

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